story while the right ear reasserts my key state at the top of my run. *A man crosses a bridge, with a piece of paper in hand. When he crosses the bridge, handing over the paper to another man, he says, 'When battle lines are crossed, fight fire with fire.'* The message is, I already have all these skills at my disposal and, when I am calm and focused and incredibly clinical, I will fight fire with fire and find a way to win. If I can do this, Mark says, I'll be the best in the world, even when the ball isn't swinging. It's a lovely idea, and it makes me excited when I hear it. It's something to aim for.

I get the impression he is not particularly confident I will listen to this tape, it seeming like quite a reach from the wordless bowler he first met, but every night I do. I begin to fall asleep with the words seeping into my pores, the goals and ambitions baking themselves into who I am.

Finally, we both identify the two cricketers on the pitch who I can really trust. When all else fails, I decide with Mark, they alone have permission to talk me out of warrior mode and to refocus me on the plan. Broady and Cooky are given licence, when they need to, to simply say, 'Remember the plan.' Rather than blowing up at them, wallowing in rage and self-pity, it would act like a key that would switch me back to neutral. Within a few balls, if I'd lost it, on hearing those words from one of those two, I'd be back into my focus, nailing my skills, hitting my areas, finding some sort of access to control my own emotions and actions. On the days we really need it, David Saker, our bowling coach, goes to find Mark Bawden on the morning of play and says, 'Just remind him, he's Jimmy today.'